

Gonzalo Bravo

MARINE BIOLOGIST · EDUCATOR · SCIENTIFIC DIVER

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Research Interests: Benthic ecology, Biodiversity monitoring, Artificial intelligence, Ocean Literacy

Education

IBIOMAR-CCT CONICET-CENPAT

Puerto Madryn, Argentina

POSTDOC

2024 - PRESENT

- Topic: Implementation of artificial intelligence tools for monitoring marine biodiversity in protected areas of Chubut.
- Director: Dr. Gregorio Bigatti, Co-director: Dr. Enrique Montes Herrera

UNPSJB(Universidad Nacional de la Patagonia San Juan Bosco)-IBIOMAR

Puerto Madryn, Argentina

PHD. IN BIOLOGICAL SCIENCES

2018 - 2024

- Thesis Topic: Biodiversity of epi-benthic communities along template rocky reefs in the Patagonian Atlantic coast: current state and modeling under a climate change scenario.
- Director: Dr. Gregorio Bigatti, Co-director: Dr. Juan Pablo Livore, Co-director: Dr. Philippe Archambault

UQAR(Université du Québec à Rimouski)

Quebec, Canada

MSC. IN OCEANOGRAPHY

2015 - 2018

- Thesis Topic: Short-term responses of Arctic deep-sea benthic macrofauna to pulses of phytodetritus.
- Advisors: Christian Nozais and Philippe Archambault

UNPSJB(Universidad Nacional de la Patagonia San Juan Bosco)

Puerto Madryn, Argentina

BSC. IN BIOLOGICAL SCIENCES

2004 - 2013

- Thesis topic: Recreational diving effects on benthic organisms in the underwater parks of Puerto Madryn, Chubut, Argentina.
- Director: Dr. Gregorio Bigatti, Co-director: Federico Márquez

Experience

Latin American Education Network for the Ocean- RELATO

Latinoamerica

ARGENTINA COORDINATOR

2020-PRESENT

- Education activities
- Web desing

Instituto de Biología de Organismos Marinos | IBIOMAR

Puerto Madryn, Argentina

MEMBER

2018-PRESENT

- Phd Student
- Postdoc

Punta Ballena

Puerto Pirámides, Argentina

SCIENTIFIC ADVICE & WHALE WATCHING GUIDE & BOAT SKIPPER

2018 - PRESENT

- Whale watching boat trips
- On board marine biologist and guide
- Boat Skipper
- Educational and sustentability advice

Marine Biodiversity Observation Network (MBOM) Pole to Pole

Puerto Madryn, Argentina

RESEARCH ASSISTANT

2019 - PRESENT

- Field assistant
- Intertidal surveys
- Data manager
- <https://marinebon.github.io>

Proyectosub

Puerto Madryn, Argentina

MEMBER

2013 - 2023

- Educational and outreach project working with marine invertebrates of Atlantic coast in Patagonia.
- Development of promotional and educational material.
- Scientific diver
- Working in a database of underwater photos and videos
- Oral presentations in schools, universities and scientific meetings

Benthic ecology Laboratory- UQAR

Rimouski, CANADA

RESEARCH ASSISTANT

2016

- Processing infaunal benthic samples from the Canadian Arctic
- Analysis of organic matter content in sediment samples
- Invertebrates macro-photography
- Data entry in trawl and boxcore database

Aquatours Buceo (Diving Center)

Puerto Madryn, Argentina

DIVING INSTRUCTOR & BOAT SKIPPER

2005 - 2013

- Recreational diving instructor, more than 3000 dives.
- Leading tour groups.
- Giving talks about the culture, language and history of the Patagonian outback.
- Assisting with security.
- Organization and development of diving courses with orientation in marine biology.
- Underwater Photography.

Publications in Scientific Journals | Books

1. **Bravo G**, Kaminsky, J., Bagur, M., Raffo, M. P., Aga Milovic, N., Piemonte, C. B., Alonso, C. P., Ocampo, E. H., Risso, S., Meyer, V., Dellatorre, F. G. (2026) *Rhodolith/Maërl Bed Coexisting with a Macrocystis pyrifera Kelp Forest in the Beagle Channel (Onashaga, Argentina)*, *Diversity*, 18(7), 402
<https://doi.org/10.3390/d18070402>
2. Trobbiani, G.; **Bravo G**; Compaire, J.C.; Merlo, P.; Tonini, M.; Mendez, M.M.; Livore, J.P.; Irigoyen (2026) *Benthic Assemblage Structure under Contrasting Current Regimes and Depth Strata in Nuevo Gulf, Patagonia, Argentina*, *Estuarine, Coastal and Shelf Science*, 337, 109908.
<https://doi.org/10.1016/j.ecss.2026.109908>
3. Kaminsky, J.; **Bravo G**; Alonso, C.P.; Rodríguez, M.; Bagur, M. (2026) *Diving into Kelp and Animal Forests in Isla de los Estados*. In: Raya Rey, A., Balza, U. (eds) *Biodiversity and Conservation of Isla de los Estados (Chuani-sin)*. Natural and Social Sciences of Patagonia. Springer, Cham.
https://doi.org/10.1007/978-3-032-13630-5_5
4. Sánchez Álvarez, Y., Villaseñor, A., **Bravo G**, Santibáñez Gómez, D.(2025) *Effectiveness of a marine education program applied in a marine protected area context and designed with science education strategies*, In T. J. Kennedy (Ed.), *Ocean Literacy: The Foundation for the Success of the Ocean Decade*, Volume II (pp. 105–124). Springer Nature Switzerland.
https://doi.org/10.1007/978-3-032-09453-7_7
5. Castro K, Battini N, **Bravo G**, Trobbiani G, Schwindt E. (2024) *Artificial wrecks: unwanted consequences of the deliberate sinking of ships for recreational diving*, *Ecologia Austral*, 35(1), 053–064.
<https://doi.org/10.25260/EA.25.35.1.0.2388>
6. **Bravo G**, Archambault P, Witte U, Mäkelä A, Kazanidis G, Ciancio JE, Bourgeois S, Nozais C. (2024) *Detritus from Ice and Plankton Algae as an Important Food Source for Macroinfaunal Communities in the Canadian Arctic*, *Diversity*. 16(10):605
<https://doi.org/10.3390/d16100605>
7. **Bravo G**, Bigatti G., Bagur M., Macaya E. C., Valdivia N., Rodriguez A., Gauna M., Walker I., Livore J. P., Mendez M. M., Nieto Vilela R., Lima F., Seabra R., Montes E.. (2024) *Implementing biodiversity monitoring of rocky shores using photo-quadrats and Artificial Intelligence in support of data-driven decision-making of marine living resources*, *Research Ideas and Outcomes*. 10
<http://dx.doi.org/10.3897/rio.10.e126660>

8. Montes Herrera E, **Bravo G**, Bigatti, G. (2023) *Sampling protocol for monitoring marine biodiversity on rocky shores. Marine Biodiversity Observation Network Pole to Pole of the Americas, Ocean Best Practices*. 10pp.
<http://dx.doi.org/10.25607/OBP-1904>
9. **Bravo G**, Kaminsky J, Bagur M, Alonso C P, Rodríguez M, Fraysse C, Lovrich G, Bigatti G. (2023) *Roving Diver Survey as a Rapid and Cost-Effective Methodology to Register Species Richness in Sub-Antarctic Kelp Forests*. *Diversity*. 15(3):354.
<https://doi.org/10.3390/d15030354>
10. **Bravo G**, Bigatti G, Penchaszadeh P, Lauretta D. (2023) *First In Situ Observation of Sperm Release in *Corynactis carnea* (Anthozoa: Corallimorpharia) from Patagonia, Argentina*. *Diversity*, 15, 287.
<https://doi.org/10.3390/d15020287>
11. **Bravo G**, Moity N, Londoño-Cruz E, Muller-Karger F, Bigatti G, Klein, E, Choi F, Parmalee L, Helmuth B, Montes E. (2021) *Robots Versus Humans: Automated Annotation Accurately Quantifies Essential Ocean Variables of Rocky Intertidal Functional Groups and Habitat*. *Frontiers in Marine Science*.
<https://doi.org/10.3389/fmars.2021.691313>
12. **Bravo G**, Livore JP, Bigatti G. (2021) *Monitoring rocky reef biodiversity by underwater geo-referenced photoquadrats*. *Underwater Technology*, Vol. 38, No. 1, pp. 17–24.
<https://doi.org/10.3723/ut.38.017>
13. **Bravo G**, Livore J.P, Battini N, Gastaldi M, Lauretta D, Brogger M.; Raffo, M P, Lagger C, Bigatti G. (2021) *Rocky Reef Biodiversity Survey: Punta Pardelas, Argentina*. *Biodiversity Data Journal*. 9, 1–13
<https://doi.org/10.3897/BDJ.9.E72081>
14. **Bravo G**, Livore JP, Bigatti G. (2020) *The importance of surface orientation in biodiversity monitoring protocols: the case of Patagonian rocky reefs*. *Frontiers in Marine Science*.
<https://doi.org/10.3389/fmars.2020.578595>
15. Battini N and **Bravo G**. (2020) *Unexpected meal: first record of predation upon a potentially neurotoxic sea slug by the European green crab *Carcinus maenas**. *New Zealand Journal of Zoology*.
<https://doi.org/10.1080/03014223.2020.1848889>
16. **Bravo G**, Márquez F, Marzinelli EM, Méndez, MM, Bigatti, G. (2015) *Effect of recreational diving on Patagonian rocky reefs*. *Marine Environmental Research* 104:31–36.
<https://doi.org/10.1016/j.marenvres.2014.12.002>

Scholarships | Awards | Grants

2025	Kelp Roots: Residency of Coexistence , Mission Blue Plum Foundation Grant	Argentina
2023	Ciencia en foco, Photography Contest – 2nd Place, Underwater Category , MINNCYT	Argentina
2020	Honourable Mention for Oral Presentation , 5th World Conference on Marine Biodiversity	New zealand
2021	”La danza del mar: ciencia y arte para la educación marina” , Grant MINNCYT	Argentina
2020	Patagonia Environmental Grant , Tides Foundation Grant	Argentina
2019	Australis young researcher award , Instituto Conservación de Ballenas	Argentina
2019	Rapid Ocean Conservation (ROC) Grants , Waitt Foundation Grant	USA
2019	Dean’s Honor List , UQAR University	Rimouski, Canada
2018	Science Exploration Education Initiative , OpenROV Trident Grant	OpenExplorer
2018	The Royal Swedish Academy of Sciences , Scholarship for scientific diving course	Sweden
2018	CONICET Ph.D scholarship , The National Scientific and Technical Research Council scholarship	Argentina
2017	Student travel award , ASLO 2017 Aquatic Sciences Meeting	Hawaii, USA
2015	BEC.AR scholarship , Argentinian scholarship for studing in CANADA	Argentina
2016	Best oral presentation , UQAR-ISMER student master project dissertation	Rimouski, CANADA

Presentations

3rd Meeting of Macroalgae Mappers

Chile

ATTENDEE, PANELIST

2026

- Organizing institution: Coastal Research Station for Marine Studies (ECIM)

XII National Marine Science Conference - XX Oceanography Colloquium

Puerto Madryn, Argentina

SPEAKER, ORGANIZING COMMITTEE MEMBER

2025

- Organizing institution: Center for the Study of Marine Systems (CESIMAR), CONICET-CENPAT

São Paulo School of Advanced Science in Ocean Literacy

Santos, Brazil

ATTENDEE

2025

- Organizing institution: Federal University of São Paulo

Marine Robotics Course and Workshop

Argentina

ATTENDEE, PANELIST

2025

- Organizing institutions: National Defense University (UNDEF), Naval Hydrography Service (SHN)

Mesophotic Reefs in Latin America: Exploration and Science II International Workshop

Brazil

ATTENDEE, SPEAKER

2025

- Organizing institutions: Center for Marine Biology (CEBIMAR-USP), Coastal Research Station for Marine Studies (ECIM)

San Julián Sea Conference (Las Jornadas del Mar en San Julián)

San Julián, Argentina

ATTENDEE, SPEAKER

2025

- Organizing institution: San Julián Academic Unit, National University of Southern Patagonia
- October 30th-31st, at the SUM of the Antiguo Hotel Colón University Residence, Av. San Martín N° 313

Workshop of the Pole to Pole Marine Biodiversity Monitoring Network of the Americas

Ushuaia, Argentina

GENERAL ORGANIZER, PANELIST, ORGANIZING COMMITTEE MEMBER, SPEAKER

2024

- Organizing institutions: National Ocean and Atmospheric Administration (NOAA), National Parks Administration (APN), Ministry of Environment and Sustainable Development
- Training workshop on marine biodiversity monitoring techniques on rocky intertidal shores using photoquadrats processed with artificial intelligence, to co-implement a monitoring network between Argentine Patagonia and the coast of Chile as part of the MBON Pole to Pole program

Workshop of the Pole to Pole Marine Biodiversity Monitoring Network of the Americas

Camarones, Argentina

GENERAL ORGANIZER, PANELIST, ORGANIZING COMMITTEE MEMBER, SPEAKER

2023

- Organizing institutions: National Ocean and Atmospheric Administration (NOAA), Institute of Marine Organisms Biology (IBIOMAR-CENPAT), CONICET
- Training workshop on marine biodiversity monitoring techniques on rocky shores of Patagonia using photoquadrats processed with artificial intelligence, as part of the MBON Pole to Pole program

1st Latin American Meeting on Marine Education

Virtual Conference

IMMERSED IN INSPIRATION: DIVING AS A SOURCE OF IDEAS FOR MARINE EDUCATION

May 2021

- Oral Presentation: **Bravo G**

5th World Conference on Marine Biodiversity - WCMB 2020

Virtual conference

THE IMPORTANCE OF SURFACE ORIENTATION IN ROCKY REEFS MONITORING

Diciembre 2020

- Presentación Oral: **Bravo G**, Livore J. P., Bigatti, G.

CommOCEAN

Conferencia virtual

DIVE INTO OUR OCEAN: DISCOVERING THE UNDERWATER WORLD OF YOUR OWN CITY

Diciembre 2020

- Oral presentation: **Bravo G**, Brogger M., Márquez F., Bigatti G.

GEO BON Open Science Conference and All Hands Meeting

Virtual conference

MACHINE LEARNING APPLICATIONS TO MONITOR MARINE ESSENTIAL BIODIVERSITY VARIABLES IN ROCKY SHORE

July 2020

COMMUNITIES

- Oral presentation: **Bravo G**, Moity N., Londoño-Cruz E., Muller-Karger F., Bigatti G., Montes E.

Workshop: Biological Essential Ocean Variables (EOVs) for the analysis of marine biodiversity patterns in rocky shores

Pto Madryn, Argentina

BENTHIC SURVEYS IN ROCKY REEFS USING PHOTOQUADRATS AND CORALNET MACHINE LEARNING

November 2019

- Oral presentation: **Bravo G**

4th World Conference on Marine Biodiversity - WCMB 2018

Montreal, Canada

DIVE INTO THE OCEAN: DISCOVERING THE UNDERWATER WORLD OF YOUR OWN CITY

May 2018

- Oral presentation: **Bravo G**, Márquez F, Brogger M., Bigatti, G.

1st National meeting of scientific diving

Puerto Madryn, Argentina

FROM THE SEABOTTOM TO SCHOOLS: OUTREACH PROGRAM PROYECTOSUB

December 2017

- Oral presentation: **Bravo G**, Márquez F, Brogger M., Bigatti, G.

International Arctic Change Conference

Quebec City, Canada

IMPORTANCE OF ICE ALGAE AND PHYTOPLANKTON DETRITUS AS FOOD SOURCES FOR THREE CONTRASTING

December 2017

MACROFAUNAL COMMUNITIES OF THE CANADIAN ARCTIC

- Poster presentation: **Bravo G**, Archambault P, Ursula W, Kazanidis G, Bourgeois S, Ciancio J, Nozais C

46th annual Benthic Ecology Meeting

Myrtle Beach, USA

SHORT-TERM RESPONSES OF ARCTIC DEEP-SEA BENTHIC MACROFAUNA TO PULSES OF PHYTODETRITUS

April 2017

- Oral presentation: **Bravo G**, Ciancio J, Ursula W, Kazanidis G, Bourgeois S, Archambault P, Nozais C

La nature dans tous ses états, UQAR outreach annual colloquium

Rimouski, Canada

VULGARISER LES INVERTÉBRÉS MARINS PAR L'IMAGE

Mach 2017

- Oral presentation: **Bravo G**

ASLO Aquatic Sciences Meeting

Hawaii, USA

SHORT-TERM RESPONSES OF ARCTIC DEEP-SEA BENTHIC MACROFAUNA TO PULSES OF PHYTODETRITUS:

January 2017

PRELIMINARY RESULTS

- Poster presentation: **Bravo G**, Ciancio J, Ursula W, Kazanidis G, Bourgeois S, Archambault P, Nozais C

Quebec Ocean annual scientific meeting

Rimouski, CANADA

SHORT-TERM RESPONSES OF ARCTIC DEEP-SEA BENTHIC MACROFAUNA TO PULSES OF PHYTODETRITUS:

November 2016

BIODIVERSITY RESULTS

- Poster presentation: **Bravo G**, Ciancio J, Ursula W, Kazanidis G, Bourgeois S, Archambault P, Nozais C

La nature dans tous ses états, UQAR outreach annual colloquium

Rimouski, CANADA

INVERTÉBRÉS MARINS COMMUNS DES RÉCIFS ROCHEUX DU GOLFE SAN JORGE, PATAGONIE ARGENTINE

March 2016

- Poster presentation: **Bravo G**, Nocera A, Márquez F, Brogger M, Bigatti G

Skills

Software	R, QGIS, OCEAN DATA VIEW, INKSCAPE, LaTeX, OSx
Languages	• Spanish (Native Language) • English (First Certificate Exam University of Cambridge) • French (TFI 745)
Outreach	• UNDERWATER 360 • INVERTEBRATES EDUCATIONAL POSTERS • INATURALIST PHOTO COLLECTION • INATURALIST GUIDE • YOUTUBE • DISCOVERING OUR SEAS: LESSONS FROM UNDER THE SEA • OCEAN LITERACY PORTAL - ARTICLE • TV SERIES